

Foundations of Group Behavior

ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR

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ELEVENTH EDITION

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After studying this chapter,
you should be able to:

- 1. Differentiate between formal and informal groups.**
- 2. Compare two models of group development.**
- 3. Explain how role requirements change in different situations.**
- 4. Describe how norms exert influence on an individual's behavior.**
- 5. Explain what determines status**
- 6. Define social loafing and its effect on group performance.**

After studying this chapter,
you should be able to:

- 7. Identify the benefits and disadvantages of cohesive groups.**
- 8. List the strengths and weaknesses of group decision making.**
- 9. Contrast the effectiveness of interacting, brainstorming, nominal and electronic meeting groups.**

Defining and Classifying Groups

Group(s)

Two or more individuals interacting and interdependent, who have come together to achieve particular objectives.

Formal Group

A designated work group defined by the organization's structure.

Informal Group

A group that is neither formally structured nor organizationally determined; appears in response to the need for social contact.

Defining and Classifying Groups (cont'd)

Command Group

A group composed of the individuals who report directly to a given manager.

Task Group

Those working together to complete a job or task.

Interest Group

Those working together to attain a specific objective with which each is concerned.

Friendship Group

Those brought together because they share one or more common characteristics.

Why People Join Groups?

- Security
- Status
- Self-esteem
- Affiliation
- Power
- Goal Achievement



EXHIBIT 8-1

The Five-Stage Model of Group Development

Forming Stage

The first stage in group development, characterized by much uncertainty.

Storming Stage

The second stage in group development, characterized by intragroup conflict.

Norming Stage

The third stage in group development, characterized by close relationships and cohesiveness.



...Group Development (cont'd)

Performing Stage

The fourth stage in group development, when the group is fully functional.

Adjourning Stage

The final stage in group development for temporary groups, characterized by concern with wrapping up activities rather than performance.



Stages of Group Development

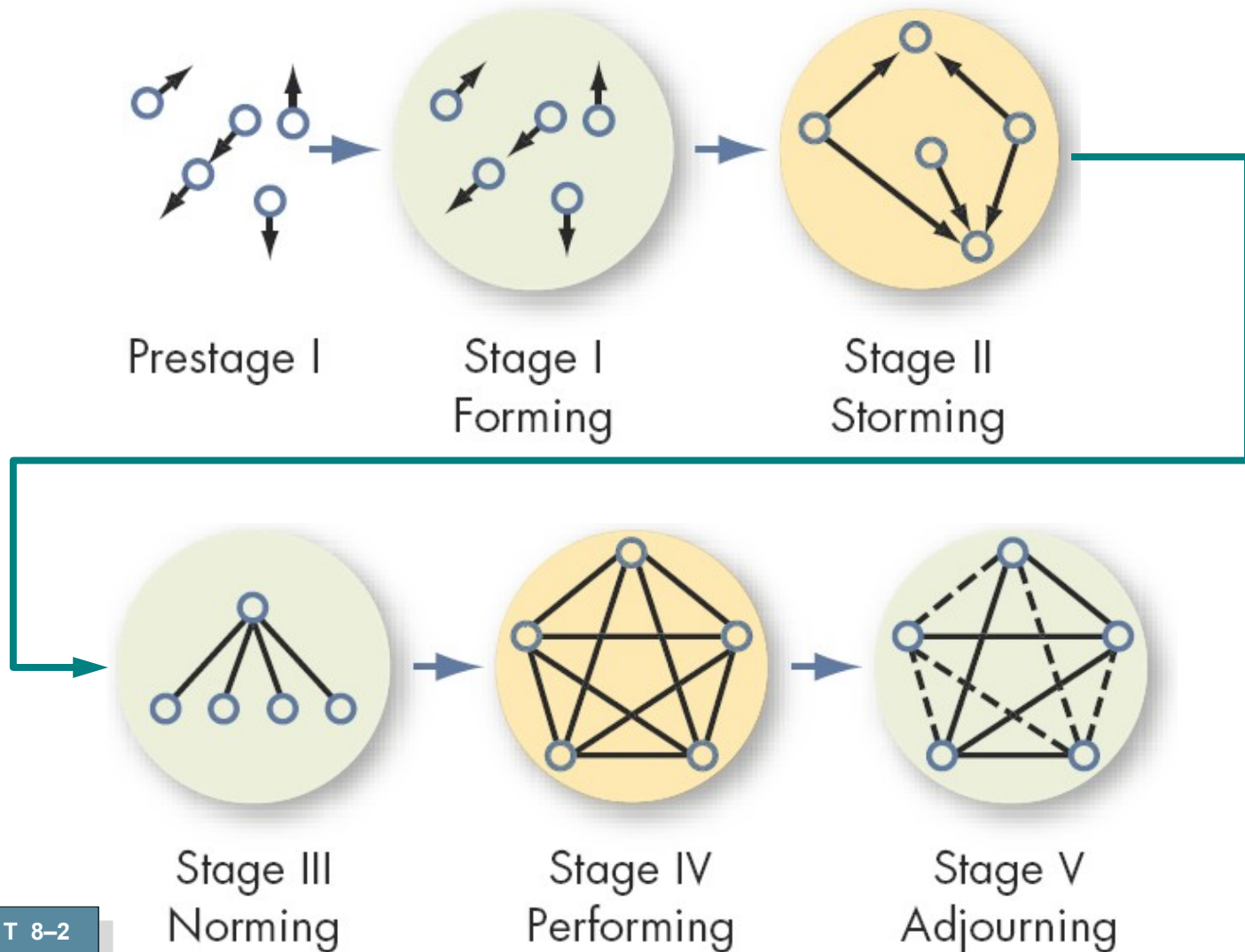


EXHIBIT 8-2

An Alternative Model: Temporary Groups with Deadlines

Punctuated-Equilibrium Model

Temporary groups go through transitions between inertia and activity.

Sequence of actions:

1. **Setting group direction**
2. **First phase of inertia**
3. **Half-way point transition**
4. **Major changes**
5. **Second phase of inertia**
6. **Accelerated activity**

The Punctuated-Equilibrium Model

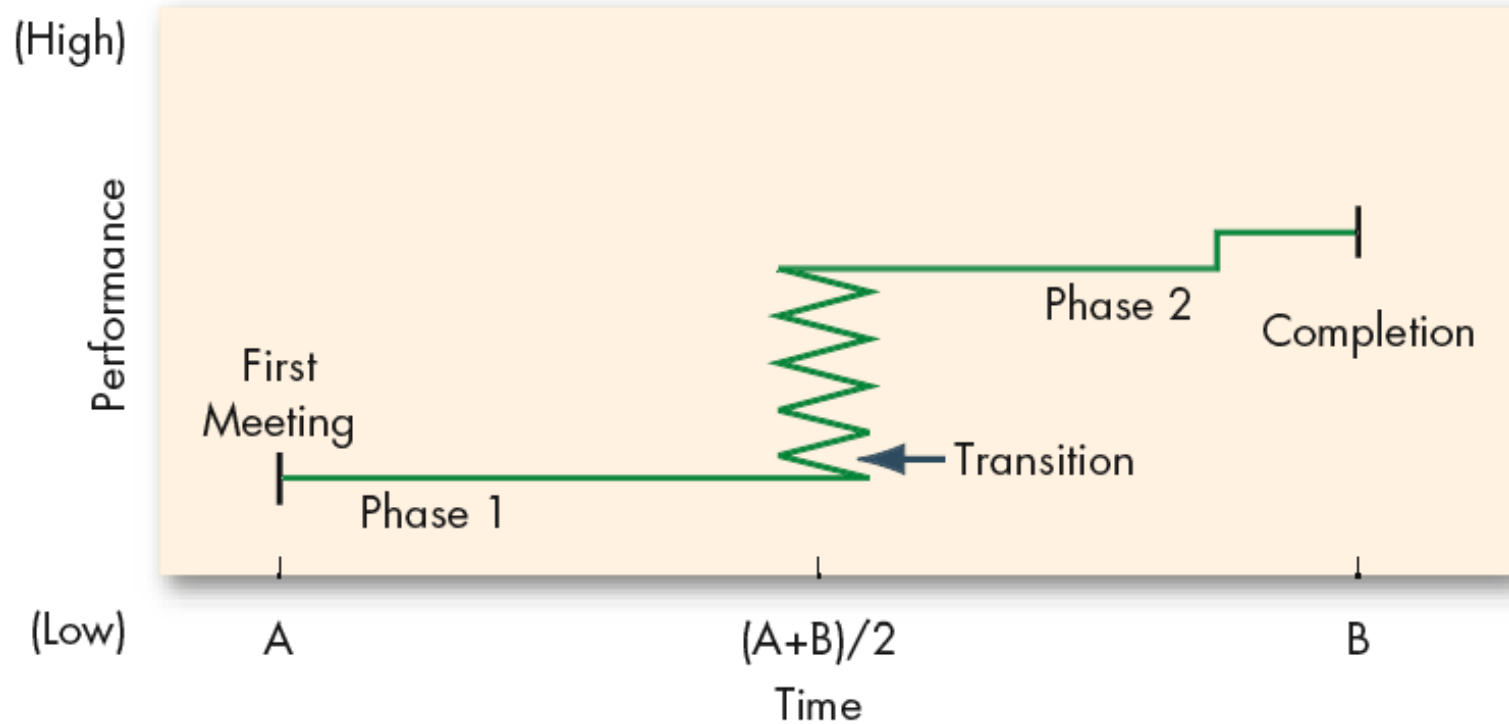


EXHIBIT 8-3

Group Structure - Roles (cont'd)

Role(s)

A set of expected behavior patterns attributed to someone occupying a given position in a social unit.

Role Identity

Certain attitudes and behaviors consistent with a role.

Role Perception

An individual's view of how he or she is supposed to act in a given situation.



Group Structure - Roles (cont'd)

Role Expectations

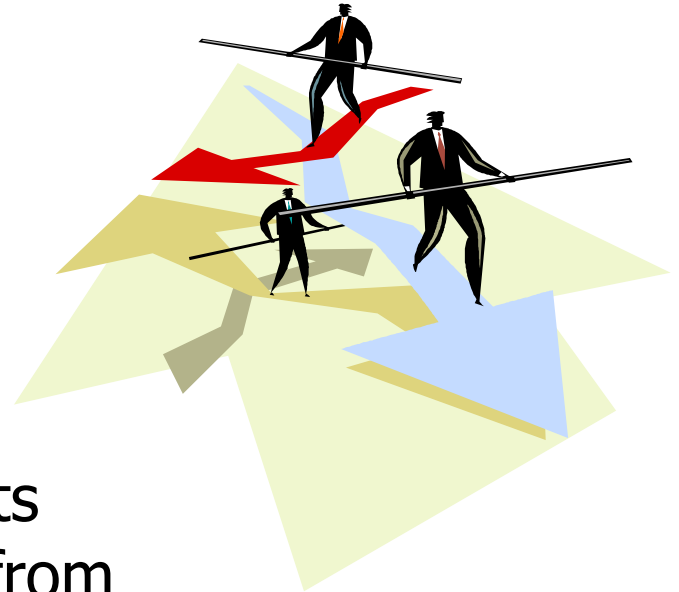
How others believe a person should act in a given situation.

Psychological Contract

An unwritten agreement that sets out what management expects from the employee and vice versa.

Role Conflict

A situation in which an individual is confronted by divergent role expectations.



Group Structure - Norms

Norms

Acceptable standards of behavior within a group that are shared by the group's members.

Classes of Norms:

- **Performance norms**
- **Appearance norms**
- **Social arrangement norms**
- **Allocation of resources norms**

The Hawthorne Studies

- **A series of studies undertaken by Elton Mayo at Western Electric Company's Hawthorne Works in Chicago between 1924 and 1932.**
- **Research Conclusions:**
 - Worker behavior and sentiments were closely related.
 - Group influences (norms) were significant in affecting individual behavior.
 - Group standards (norms) were highly effective in establishing individual worker output.
 - Money was less a factor in determining worker output than were group standards, sentiments, and security.

Group Structure - Norms (cont'd)

Conformity

Adjusting one's behavior to align with the norms of the group.

Reference Groups

Important groups to which individuals belong or hope to belong and with whose norms individuals are likely to conform.



Examples of Cards Used in Asch's Study

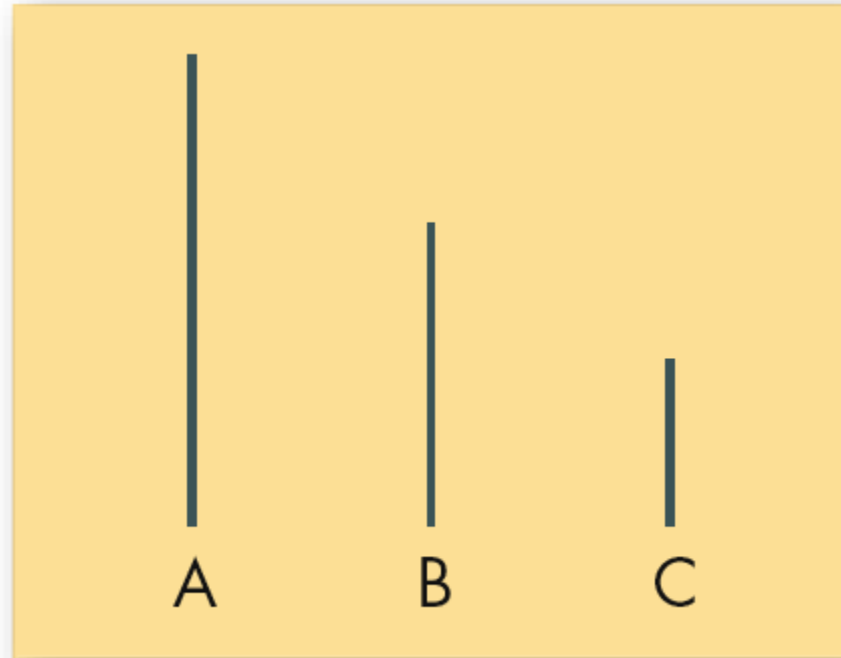
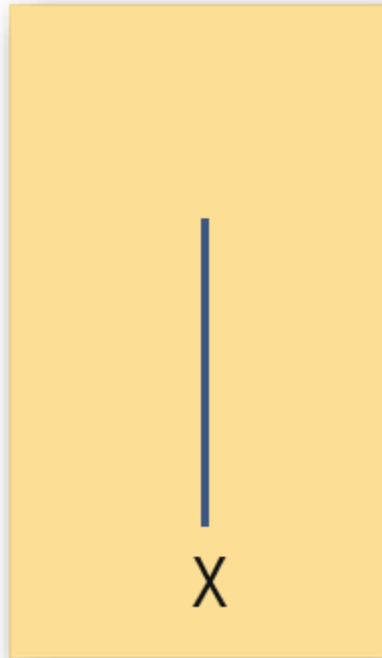


EXHIBIT 8-4

Group Structure - Norms (cont'd)

Deviant Workplace Behavior

Antisocial actions by organizational members that intentionally violate established norms and result in negative consequences for the organization, its members, or both.



Typology of Deviant Workplace Behavior

Category	Examples
Production	Leaving early Intentionally working slowly Wasting resources
Property	Sabotage Lying about hours worked Stealing from the organization
Political	Showing favoritism Gossiping and spreading rumors Blaming coworkers
Personal Aggression	Sexual harassment Verbal abuse Stealing from coworkers

Source: Adapted from S.L. Robinson, and R.J. Bennett. "A Typology of Deviant Workplace Behaviors: A Multidimensional Scaling Study," *Academy of Management Journal*, April 1995, p. 565.

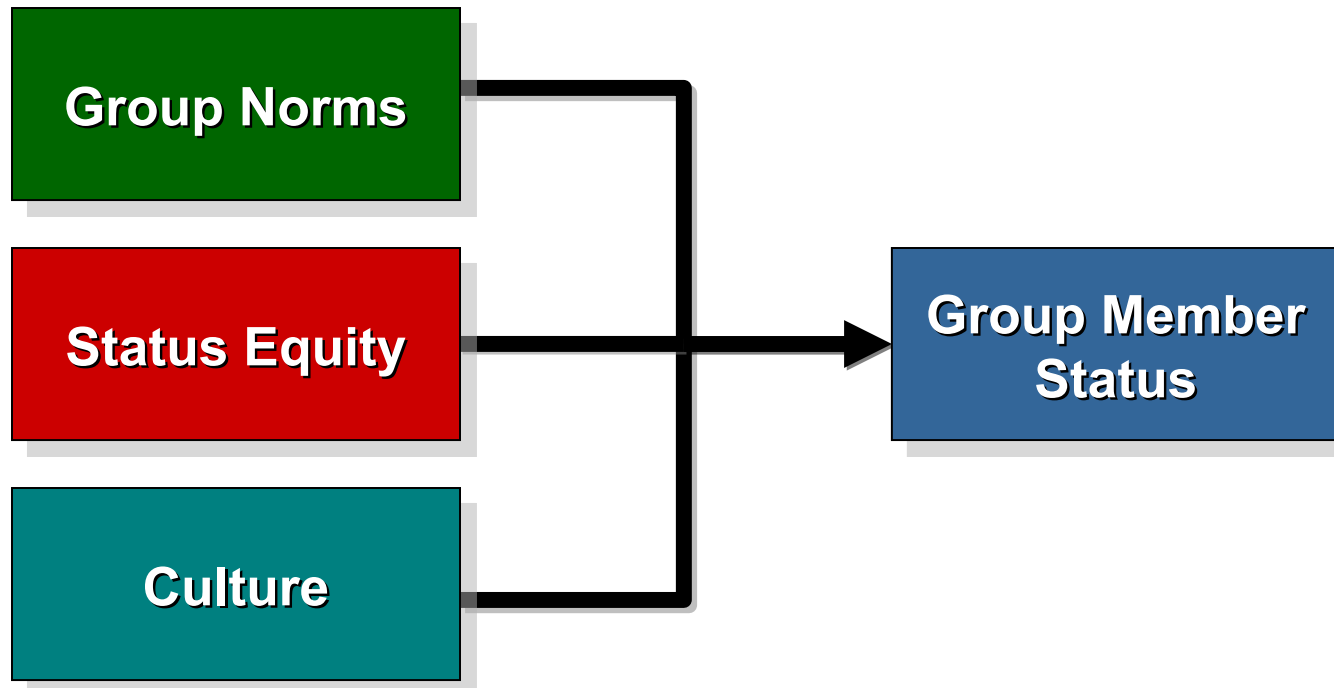
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EXHIBIT 8-5

Group Structure - Status

Status

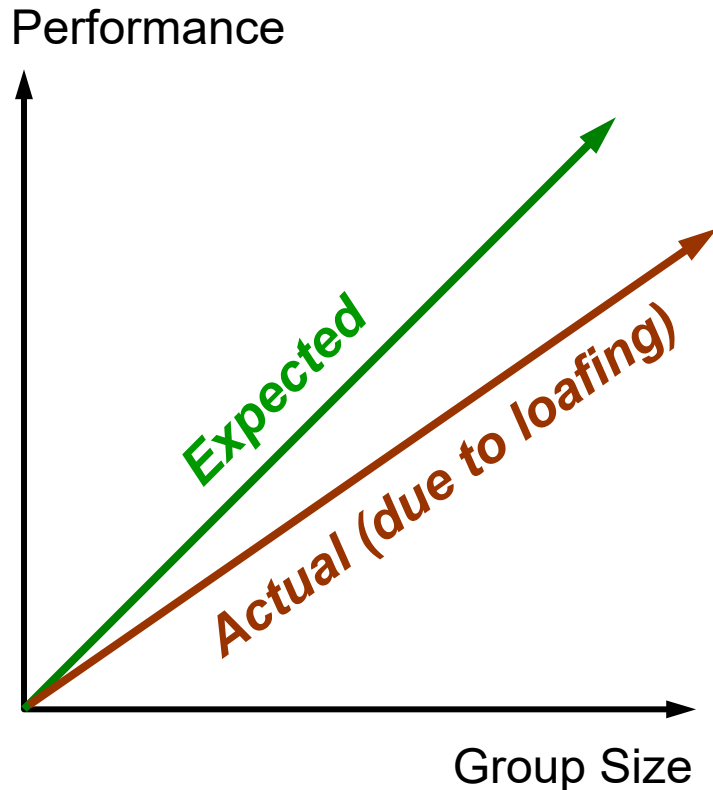
A socially defined position or rank given to groups or group members by others.



Group Structure - Size

Social Loafing

The tendency for individuals to expend less effort when working collectively than when working individually.



Other conclusions:

- Odd number groups do better than even.
- Groups of 7 or 9 perform better overall than larger or smaller groups.

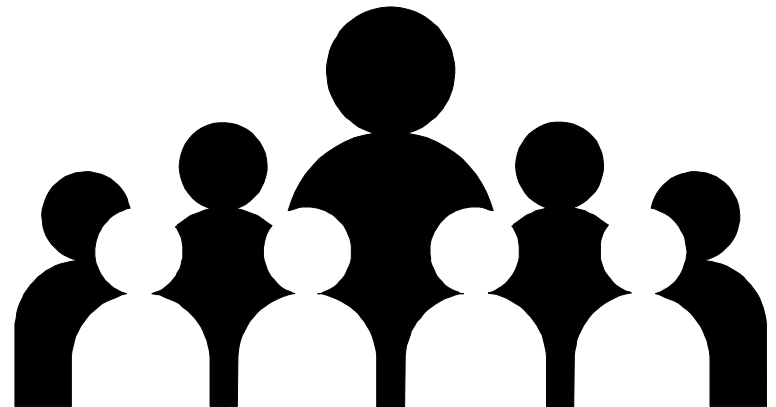
Group Structure - Composition

Group Demography

The degree to which members of a group share a common demographic attribute, such as age, sex, race, educational level, or length of service in the organization, and the impact of this attribute on turnover.

Cohorts

Individuals who, as part of a group, hold a common attribute.



Group Structure - Cohesiveness

Cohesiveness

Degree to which group members are attracted to each other and are motivated to stay in the group.

Increasing group cohesiveness:

1. Make the group smaller.
2. Encourage agreement with group goals.
3. Increase time members spend together.
4. Increase group status and admission difficulty.
5. Stimulate competition with other groups.
6. Give rewards to the group, not individuals.
7. Physically isolate the group.

Relationship Between Group Cohesiveness, Performance Norms, and Productivity

		Cohesiveness	
		High	Low
Performance norms	High	High productivity	Moderate productivity
	Low	Low productivity	Moderate to low productivity

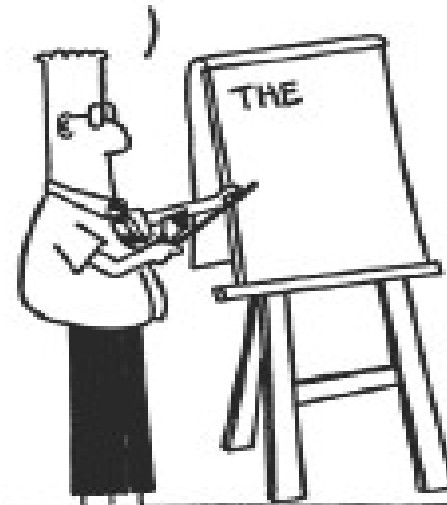
EXHIBIT 8-6

GROUP WRITING

FEW THINGS IN LIFE ARE LESS EFFICIENT THAN A GROUP OF PEOPLE TRYING TO WRITE A SENTENCE. THE ADVANTAGE OF THIS METHOD IS THAT YOU END UP WITH SOMETHING FOR WHICH YOU WILL NOT BE PERSONALLY BLAMED.



HOW'S THIS FOR A START?



IT MIGHT OFFEND PEOPLE NAMED "THEDODORE."

THAT'S A LOADED WORD.

IT'S OVERUSED, IF YOU ASK ME.

THIS AIN'T SHAKESPEARE ; LET'S USE WORDS WE ALL UNDERSTAND.

Group Tasks (**Group DM vs Individual DM**)

➤ **Decision-making**

- Large groups facilitate the pooling of information about complex tasks.
- Smaller groups are better suited to coordinating and facilitating the implementation of complex tasks.
- Simple, routine standardized tasks reduce the requirement that group processes be effective in order for the group to perform well.

Group Decision Making

➤ Strengths

- More complete information
- Increased diversity of views
- Higher quality of decisions (more accuracy)
- Increased acceptance of solutions

➤ Weaknesses

- More time consuming (slower)
- Increased pressure to conform
- Domination by one or a few members
- Ambiguous responsibility

Group Decision Making (cont'd) (Dec 30, 2023)

Groupthink

Phenomenon in which the norm for consensus overrides the realistic appraisal of alternative course of action.

Groupshift

A change in decision risk between the group's decision and the individual decision that member within the group would make; can be either toward conservatism or greater risk.

Symptoms Of The Groupthink Phenomenon

- **Group members rationalize any resistance to the assumptions they have made.**
- **Members apply direct pressures on those who express doubts about shared views or who question the alternative favored by the majority.**
- **Members who have doubts or differing points of view keep silent about misgivings.**
- **There appears to be an illusion of unanimity.**

Group Decision-Making Techniques

Interacting Groups

Typical groups, in which the members interact with each other face-to-face.

Nominal Group Technique

A group decision-making method in which individual members meet face-to-face to pool their judgments in a systematic but independent fashion.



Group Decision-Making Techniques

Brainstorming

An idea-generation process that specifically encourages any and all alternatives, while withholding any criticism of those alternatives.

Electronic Meeting

A meeting in which members interact on computers, allowing for anonymity of comments and aggregation of votes.



Evaluating Group Effectiveness

Effectiveness Criteria	TYPE OF GROUP			
	Interacting	Brainstorming	Nominal	Electronic
Number and quality of ideas	Low	Moderate	High	High
Social pressure	High	Low	Moderate	Low
Money costs	Low	Low	Low	High
Speed	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate
Task orientation	Low	High	High	High
Potential for interpersonal conflict	High	Low	Moderate	Low
Commitment to solution	High	Not applicable	Moderate	Moderate
Development of group cohesiveness	High	High	Moderate	Low

EXHIBIT 8-8